

Primary Directions

A primary direction forms because the earth rotates daily on its axis. The horizon moves in the direction of the signs of the zodiac. The planets therefore appear to move in the opposite direction.

Time Keys

The movement of primary directions is approximately 1 degree per year. The measure for the movement is the *time key*. There are multiple time keys with small differences between them. As a person gets older the differences increase: a difference of 1 arc minute amounts to one degree after 60 years. In time that will then differ by one year.

Five Variants

Enigma supports five time keys: the keys of Ptolemy, Naibod, Brahe, Placidus and van Dam.

TIME KEY	DESCRIPTION
Ptolemy	1 degree per year in right ascension.
Naibod	The mean tropical day, which is 0°59'08" per year, measured in right ascension.
Brahe	The movement of the Sun on the day of birth, per year and measured in right ascension.
Placidus	The difference between the position of the secondary Sun and the radix Sun, measured in right ascension.
van Dam	The difference between the position of the secondary Sun and the radix Sun, measured in ecliptic longitude.

Promissors and Significators

The planet that moves is called the *promissor*, the planet that remains fixed at the position as in the radix is called the *significator*. In the configuration you specify which planets you want to use in these roles. A planet will often have both roles: it can move towards a point in the radix (promissor) but when another planet moves towards the radix position it takes on the role of significator.

The Different Systems

Enigma supports two systems for primary directions: according to Placidus and Regiomontanus. The calculations are analogous to the calculation for the houses, but primary directions and houses are entirely different matters. It is perfectly possible to work with Placidus for primary directions and use equal houses for the radix.

Directions according to both Placidus and Regiomontanus can be calculated mundane or zodiacal. In a mundane direction you move the point that exactly coincides with the planet, thus taking into account the latitude of that planet. In zodiacal directions you do not move the point where the planet is located but the corresponding position on the ecliptic. The latitude of the planet is then disregarded.



1. Gansten, Martin - *Primary directions. Astrology's old master technique.* Bournemouth, 2009.
2. Gansten, Martin - *Annual predictive techniques of the Greek, Arabic & Indian astrologers.* Swanage, 2020.
3. Makransky, Bob - *Primary directions: a primer of calculation.* Occidental CA, 1988
4. Plantiko, Rüdiger - *Primärdirektionen: Eine Darstellung ihrer Technik.* Mössingen, 1996.